STUDY AID · MATTHEW 24:36-51 · EPISODE 47 (#50 OF 58 IN THE PLAYLIST)

As in the Days *of Noah*



Be ready

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 24:36-51 in the LSB | 35:44 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: Jesus' Final Warning Before Judgment... Are We Overlooking It?. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO | BACKGROUND (ADDED) | DEBATED | LSB TEXT | ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 24:36-51. No one knows that day and hour, not even the angels or the Son, but the Father alone. As in the days of Noah, people ate, drank and married until the flood took them all away; so will the coming of the Son of Man be. Two in the field, two women at the mill: one taken, one left. Stay awake, like a head of the house who knows a thief is coming. Who then is the faithful and prudent slave, found feeding the household when the master comes? The evil slave who says, 'My master is not coming for a long time,' is cut in pieces and put with the hypocrites.
- 'That day and hour' is the language of the day of Yahweh (Isaiah 13:6, 9; Ezekiel 13:5; Joel 1:15; Zephaniah 1:7). The video still reads the discourse as answering the disciples' question about the fall of the temple and Jerusalem, now filled with that imagery.
- Noah's long work on the ark was itself a sign; when the flood came, it was sudden and severe. So with Jerusalem: about 40 years from the prophecy, and four years from the revolt of AD 66, with Galilee and other towns taken first. Eusebius reports that the Jerusalem church left for Pella before the war.
- In Genesis 6, the earth was 'corrupt' (shachat) and God would 'destroy' (shachat) it: mankind had corrupted itself, so God destroyed it. Jesus sees the same in the corrupt leaders of His generation (23:34-36). God's household is the whole world, with the temple as a

> *"In a world of corruption that the Lord will judge, God's people must focus more than ever on fulfilling their calling and the ultimate purpose for their creation."*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Every day that Noah built this gigantic structure was a sign to the people around him that God's judgment was coming."*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

microcosm; the faithful slave keeps doing the master's work.

- The lesson: in a world of corruption that the Lord will judge, God's people must focus more than ever on fulfilling their calling and the ultimate purpose for their creation. If they do this, they will be blessed on the day of God's judgment.

Do a word study

Look up a key word in the original language and trace where else it is used: in Genesis 6 one Hebrew verb means both 'corrupt' and 'destroy.'

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB. This is Episode 47 of the Matthew study (playlist item 50).

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 24:36-51 and turns to Genesis 1 and 6, Isaiah 13, Zephaniah 1, Joel 2, Acts 2, Matthew 23, Exodus 19 and 2 Corinthians 4. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 24:36-51
Read in full: the unknown hour and the faithful slave.

Matthew 24:3
The disciples' question.

Genesis 6:11-13
The earth was corrupt; I am about to destroy them.

Genesis 6:17
The flood, to destroy all flesh.

Isaiah 13:6
The day of Yahweh is near.

Zephaniah 1:7
The day of Yahweh is near.

Joel 2:1-11
A day of darkness; an army; sun and moon grow dark.

Joel 2:28-29
I will pour out My Spirit on all mankind.

Acts 2:14-21
Peter at Pentecost: this is what was spoken through Joel.

Matthew 23:34-36
All these things will come upon this generation.

Genesis 1:28
Be fruitful and multiply; have dominion.

Exodus 19:6
A kingdom of priests and a holy nation.

2 Corinthians 4:3-4
The god of this age has blinded the minds.

Key verses in the LSB

“But of that day and hour no one knows, not even the angels of heaven, nor the Son, but the Father alone.”
Matthew 24:36 (LSB)

“For this reason you also must be ready; for the Son of Man is coming at an hour when you do not think He will.”
Matthew 24:44 (LSB)

“Blessed is that slave whom his master finds so doing when he comes.”
Matthew 24:46 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

As in the days of Noah

The unknown hour, a slow sign, and one taken, one left.



MATTHEW 24:36

That day and hour

MATTHEW 24:36 (LSB)

NO ONE KNOWS

““But of that day and hour no one knows, not even the angels of heaven, nor the Son, but the Father alone.”

FROM THE VIDEO 'That day and hour' looks back to the disciples' question in 24:3 and imports the Old Testament day of Yahweh, applied here to the fall of the temple and Jerusalem.

FROM THE VIDEO The central concern is vigilance: Jesus does not want them caught off guard.

FROM THE VIDEO The video says Josephus tells of Vespasian attacking Jewish outposts at odd hours of the night to catch them by surprise (Jewish War, book 4).

◆ Factbook: Day of the Lord ◆ Factbook: Angel



MATTHEW 24:37-39; GENESIS 6

The days of Noah

JESUS · MATTHEW 24:38-39

LUKE · LUKE 17:27

“For as in those days before the flood they were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day that Noah entered the ark, and they did not understand until the flood came and took them all away; so will the coming of the Son of Man be.”

“they were eating, they were drinking, they were marrying, they were being given in marriage, until the day that Noah entered the ark, and the flood came and destroyed them all.”

FROM THE VIDEO The ark took a long time to build. Every day of building was a sign that judgment was coming; when the flood came, it was sudden and severe.

FROM THE VIDEO So with Jerusalem: around 40 years from prophecy to destruction, and four years from the revolt of AD 66, with Galilee and other towns taken first. Many trusted the walls and ignored the signs.

◆ Factbook: Noah ◆ Factbook: Galilee



MATTHEW 24:40-44

One taken, one left

MATTHEW 24:40-42 (LSB)

READY

“Then there will be two in the field; one will be taken, and one will be left. Two women will be grinding grain at the mill; one will be taken and one will be left. “Therefore stay awake, for you do not know which day your Lord is coming.”

FROM THE VIDEO In the video's reading, the ones taken are spared because they obeyed Jesus and remembered what He told them; the others are left to endure the judgment on the city.

BACKGROUND Eusebius: 'the people of the church in Jerusalem had been commanded by a revelation, vouchsafed to approved men there before the war, to leave the city and to dwell in a certain town of Perea called Pella' (Church History 3.5.3).

BACKGROUND Paul uses the thief image too: 'the day of the Lord will come just like a thief in the night' (1 Thessalonians 5:2).

1 Thessalonians 5:2

◆ Factbook: Perea ◆ Factbook: Decapolis



Until the day that Noah entered the ark

Edward Hicks, Noah's Ark, 1846. Philadelphia Museum of Art via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"Every day that Noah built this gigantic structure was a sign to the people around him that God's judgment was coming.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The day of Yahweh

Joel's army, Peter at Pentecost, and a word study in Genesis 6.

JOEL 2:1-2, 10

The day of Yahweh

JOEL 2:1-2 (LSB)

JOEL

"Blow a trumpet in Zion, / And make a loud shout on My holy mountain! / Let all the inhabitants of the land tremble, / For the day of Yahweh is coming; / Surely it is near, A day of darkness and thick darkness, / A day of clouds and dense gloom. / As the dawn is spread over the mountains, / So there is a numerous and mighty people; / There has never been anything like it, / Nor will there be again after it / For the years from generation to generation."

FROM THE VIDEO The day of Yahweh comes with an army marching on a city, and 'The sun and the moon grow dark' (Joel 2:10), the way Jesus speaks in Matthew 24. Joel 2:10

◆ Factbook: Joel (the prophet) ◆ Factbook: Day of the Lord

JOEL 2:28; ACTS 2:16-17

Afterwards, the Spirit

JOEL · JOEL 2:28

““And it will be afterwards / That I will pour out My Spirit on all mankind; / And your sons and your daughters shall prophesy; / Your old men will dream dreams; / Your young men will see visions.”

PETER · ACTS 2:16-17

“but this is what was spoken through the prophet Joel: ‘And it shall be in the last days,’ God says, / ‘That I will pour out My Spirit on all mankind;”

FROM THE VIDEO Peter says Joel's promise is here at Pentecost, wonders and signs included (Acts 2:19-20). The culmination, in the video's reading, is the destruction of the temple and Jerusalem in AD 70. Acts 2:19-20

◆ Factbook: Pentecost ◆ Factbook: Holy Spirit ◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter)

GENESIS 6:11-13, 17

Corrupt, so destroyed

GENESIS · GENESIS 6:12

“And God saw the earth, and behold, it was corrupt; for all flesh had corrupted their way upon the earth.”

GOD TO NOAH · GENESIS 6:13

“Then God said to Noah, “The end of all flesh has come before Me; for the earth is filled with violence because of them; and behold, I am about to destroy them with the earth.”

FROM THE VIDEO The Hebrew shachat is used three times in 6:11-12 for 'corrupt,' then for God's 'destroy' in 6:13 and 6:17. Mankind corrupted itself, so God destroyed it. Genesis 6:17

FROM THE VIDEO The same pattern lies behind 'all these things will come upon this generation' (23:36). Matthew 23:36

◆ Factbook: Noah ◆ Factbook: Judgment

> *“Mankind had become so shachat that God shachat mankind.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The faithful and prudent slave

So doing when he comes: God's household and our calling.

MATTHEW 24:45-47

The faithful and prudent slave

MATTHEW 24:45-47 (LSB)

SO DOING

““Who then is the faithful and prudent slave whom his master put in charge of his household to give them their food at the proper time? Blessed is that slave whom his master finds so doing when he comes. Truly I say to you that he will put him in charge of all his possessions.”

FROM THE VIDEO The master blesses the slave doing what he was told, feeding the household, not the one trying to work out when the master returns.

FROM THE VIDEO The disciples did not need to decode the signs: they would be obvious, and there would be time between the birth pains and the end to act as faithful servants.

◆ Factbook: Parable



GENESIS 1:28; EXODUS 19:6

God's household

GOD TO HUMANITY · GENESIS 1:28

“God blessed them, and God said to them, “Be fruitful and multiply, and fill the earth, and subdue it; and have dominion over the fish of the sea and over the birds of the sky and over every living thing that creeps on the earth.””

GOD TO ISRAEL · EXODUS 19:6

“and you shall be to Me a kingdom of priests and a holy nation.’ These are the words that you shall speak to the sons of Israel.””

FROM THE VIDEO Dominion is borrowed authority: the world is God's house, and the temple, decorated with earthly and cosmic images, was its microcosm.

FROM THE VIDEO Humanity refused its mandate and became corrupt; so did the leaders of Jesus' day. Those who truly know God will replace them as a better kingdom of priests.

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish) ◆ Factbook: Priest



MATTHEW 24:48-51; 2 CORINTHIANS 4:4

'My master is not coming'

JESUS · MATTHEW 24:48-50

“But if that evil slave says in his heart, ‘My master is not coming for a long time,’ and begins to beat his fellow slaves and eat and drink with drunkards; the master of that slave will come on a day when he does not expect him and at an hour which he does not know,”

PAUL · 2 CORINTHIANS 4:4

“in whose case the god of this age has blinded the minds of the unbelieving so that they might not see the light of the gospel of the glory of Christ, who is the image of God.”

FROM THE VIDEO The world is still corrupt; leaders in church and society still lead the flock astray. We keep spreading God's kingdom and shining the light of Christ until Jesus returns, whenever that is.

BACKGROUND 'Weeping and gnashing of teeth' (24:51) recurs in 8:12, 13:42, 13:50, 22:13 and 25:30. Matthew 8:12 Matthew 25:30

◆ Factbook: Hypocrite ◆ Factbook: Outer darkness ◆ Factbook: Paul



The judgment on the city

Francesco Hayez, The Destruction of the Temple of Jerusalem, 1867. Gallerie dell'Accademia, Venice, via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"The actual command of Jesus is not to spend countless hours determining the signs of his coming and when specifically that will be.*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in 24:36-51

What the video says, then a short background note.

Noah

VIDEO His long work on the ark was a sign of coming judgment.

BACKGROUND Hebrews 11:7 and 2 Peter 2:5 call him a preacher of righteousness by faith.

Genesis 6:13-22 | Hebrews 11:7 | ◆ Noah | ◆ The flood | ◆ Noah's ark

The faithful and prudent slave

VIDEO Found feeding the household when the master comes.

BACKGROUND Luke 12:42-46 tells the same parable.

Matthew 24:45 | Luke 12:42

The evil slave

VIDEO Thinks he has all the time in the world.

BACKGROUND His end is with the hypocrites, as in chapter 23.

Matthew 24:48-51 | ◆ Hypocrite

Vespasian

VIDEO Roman general who began the war.

BACKGROUND He subdued Galilee in AD 67, then became emperor in AD 69 and left the siege to his son Titus.

Luke 21:20 | ◆ Galilee | ◆ Vespasian

◆ Titus (emperor)

Eusebius

VIDEO Church historian who tells of the Christians' flight to Pella.

BACKGROUND Bishop of Caesarea; wrote his Church History in the early 300s.

Matthew 24:16 ◆ Eusebius of Caesarea

07 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND

Jerusalem, Pella and the war

Pins outlined in the video's color are places the video names. Gold pins are background.



● Named in the video ● Background

Positions from known sites; the route to Pella is schematic. Eusebius places Pella in Perea; it was one of the cities of the Decapolis. Coastline, Dead Sea and most rivers: Natural Earth (public domain). Sea of Galilee outline and the Yarmuk River: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Jerusalem VIDEO

Pella VIDEO

The city whose fall the disciples asked about (24:3).

◆ Factbook: Jerusalem

Where Eusebius says the Jerusalem church went before the war.

◆ Factbook: Decapolis ◆ Factbook: Pella

Jotapata BACKGROUND

Galilean town Vespasian besieged in AD 67, where Josephus surrendered.

◆ Factbook: Galilee

Caesarea Maritima BACKGROUND

Vespasian's headquarters for the war.

◆ Factbook: Caesarea Maritima

08

Key terms

Day of the Lord

VIDEO

The day of Yahweh: His coming in judgment, and salvation for His people (Joel 2; Zephaniah 1).

◆ Factbook: Day of the Lord

Shachat

VIDEO

Hebrew verb meaning to corrupt or ruin, and to destroy (Genesis 6:11-17).

Household

VIDEO

The master's house and its people; in the video, God's world, with the temple as its microcosm.

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

Kingdom of priests

VIDEO

Israel's calling in Exodus 19:6, taken up for the church in 1 Peter 2:9.

◆ Factbook: Priest

Pella

VIDEO

A city of the Decapolis east of the Jordan, where Eusebius says Jerusalem's Christians fled.

◆ Factbook: Decapolis ◆ Factbook: Pella

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

ὥρα

γρηγορέω

hōra G5610

Hour, appointed time.

Greek · Matt 24:36

grēgoreō G1127

To stay awake, keep watch.

Greek · Matt 24:42

πιστός

pistos G4103

Faithful, trustworthy.

Greek · Matt 24:45

φρόνιμος

phronimos G5429

Prudent, wise, sensible.

Greek · Matt 24:45

δοῦλος

doulos G1401

Slave, servant.

Greek · Matt 24:45

διχοτομέω

dichotomeō G1371

To cut in two; to punish severely.

Greek · Matt 24:51

שָׁחַת

shachat H7843

To corrupt, ruin; to destroy. Look up: HALOT, שׁחת.

Hebrew · Gen 6:11, 12, 13, 17

◆ Factbook: Noah

חָמָס

hamas H2555

Violence, wrong.

Hebrew · Gen 6:11, 13

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

The flight to Pella

Eusebius, writing in the early 300s, says the Jerusalem church was warned by a revelation before the war and moved to Pella. Many readers connect it with 'those who are in Judea must flee to the mountains' (24:16); some historians question the report.

The Jewish War, AD 66–70

The revolt began in AD 66. Vespasian took Galilee in 67, including Jotapata, and much of Judea by 68. After he became emperor, his son Titus besieged Jerusalem in AD 70.

Grinding at the mill

Women ground grain daily on hand mills, often in pairs at a rotary quern, so two women at the mill is an everyday scene.

SOURCED

Early witnesses

> *But the people of the church in Jerusalem had been commanded by a revelation, vouchsafed to approved men there before the war, to leave the city and to dwell in a certain town of Perea called Pella.*

Eusebius of Caesarea, c. AD 325. Church History 3.5.3. NPNF 2.1 (public domain).

> *So for this cause He spoke also of the days of Noe, for this cause He said too, Two shall be on the bed, signifying this, that He should come upon them thus unexpectedly.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 77, on 24:40-41. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *Watch therefore, for you know not what hour your Lord does come.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 77, quoting 24:42. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

Taken to safety, or taken away?

The video reads 'taken' as spared, like the Christians who fled. Others note that the flood 'took them all away' (24:39), so the one taken is swept away in judgment and the one left is spared.

AD 70 or the final coming?

The video applies 24:36-51 to the fall of Jerusalem. Many interpreters see a turn at 24:36 from the near event to the final coming, whose day no one knows.

The temple as a small cosmos

Some scholars argue that the temple was seen as a model of the world; others think the evidence for this is thinner in the first century.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- Pentecost came 50 days after Passover, about ten days after the ascension (Acts 1:3 gives forty days of appearances); the video says 50 days after Jesus ascended.
- Eusebius credits the flight to Pella to 'a revelation, vouchsafed to approved men there before the war'; he does not say they remembered the Olivet Discourse.
- The video counts eight woes in Matthew 23; the previous episode counted seven (eight with the bracketed 23:14).

- The claim that Noah took 100 years to build the ark comes from later tradition; Genesis gives his age at 500 (5:32) and at the flood (7:6) but not the building time.
- The Josephus account of night attacks is summarized from the video; it is not checked here.

11 · BACKGROUND

From Noah to Eusebius

Coral dots mark what Matthew 24:36-51 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

PRIMEVAL DEBATED
Noah and the flood
Genesis 6:11-13 *Recalled: 24:37-39*

C. 1446 BC DEBATED
'A kingdom of priests'
Exodus 19:6

C. 400S BC DEBATED
Joel: the day of Yahweh
Joel 2:1-2

C. AD 30 DEBATED
The faithful and prudent slave
Matthew 24:36-51 *This episode*

AD 30 DEBATED
Pentecost: 'this is what was spoken'
Acts 2:16-17

AD 66-70 DEBATED
The Jewish War; flight to Pella
Matthew 24:16

C. AD 325
Eusebius records the flight
Matthew 24:16

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Luke 17:26-37
As in the days of Noah and Lot
ADDED

Luke 12:35-48
Be dressed and ready
ADDED

1 Thessalonians 5:1-6

2 Peter 3:3-10

Like a thief in the night

ADDED

Where is the promise of His coming?

ADDED

1 Peter 2:9

A royal priesthood

ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1. Why does Jesus refuse to give a date?
2. In what ways was Noah's ark a sign to his neighbors?
3. What does 'shachat' teach about what corruption does to people?
4. What has the master given you to do 'at the proper time'?
5. Where are you tempted to say, 'My master is not coming for a long time'?
6. How can you keep doing the work of the kingdom in a corrupt world without fear?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson: in a world of corruption that the Lord will judge, God's people must focus more than ever on fulfilling their calling and the ultimate purpose for their creation. If they do, they will be blessed on the day of God's judgment. The all-seeing God wants to find His people busy with the work He has given them, out of the overflow of their relationship with Him. The world is still corrupt and the god of this age still blinds minds, so we keep spreading God's kingdom, trust the Lord, and put one foot in front of the other.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

write down the 'household' the Lord has put you over (family, work, church) and one way to 'give them their food at the proper time' this week.

> *In a world of corruption that the Lord will judge, God's people must focus more than ever on fulfilling their calling and the ultimate purpose for their creation.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Jordan River ◆ Isaiah ◆ Flavius Josephus ◆ Holy Spirit ◆ Judgment ◆ Galilee
◆ Pentecost ◆ Righteousness ◆ Angel ◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Jerusalem ◆ Decapolis
◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Disciples ◆ Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ Hypocrite ◆ Judea ◆ Noah ◆ Perea
◆ Sea of Galilee ◆ Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Joel (the prophet) ◆ Outer darkness ◆ Paul ◆ Priest
◆ Son of Man ◆ Zephaniah (the prophet) ◆ Caesarea Maritima ◆ Parable ◆ Day of the Lord ◆ Passover
◆ Church ◆ Marriage ◆ Noah's ark ◆ Ascension of Jesus ◆ Birth pangs ◆ Eusebius of Caesarea
◆ The flood ◆ Pella ◆ Titus (emperor) ◆ Vespasian

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